

DOGFISH SHARKS AND RELATIVES

A large and varied order, the Squaliformes contains at least 143 species and includes gulper, lantern, sleeper, and kitefin sharks. These all have two dorsal (back) fins and no anal fin. All species so far studied bear live young.



PIKED DOGFISH
Squalus acanthias
F: Squalidae

Found worldwide in temperate waters this once hugely abundant shark is endangered by overfishing. Living up to an age of 100, it grows and breeds very slowly.



COOKIECUTTER SHARK
Isistius brasiliensis
F: Dalatiidae

This widespread, tropical shark is an ectoparasite of dolphins and large fish. Sucking on with thick lips, it twists round and bites out a round plug of flesh.



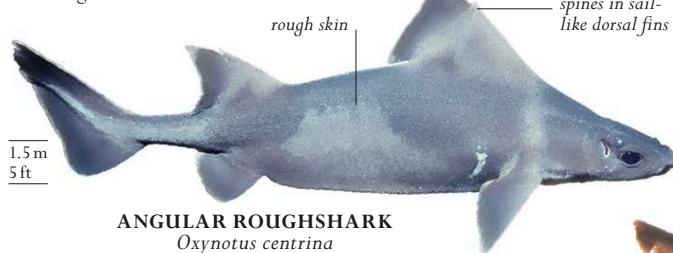
VELVET BELLY LANTERN SHARK
Etmopterus spinax
F: Etmopteridae

This lantern shark lives in the deep E. Atlantic. It has tiny light organs on its belly, which help in finding a mate.



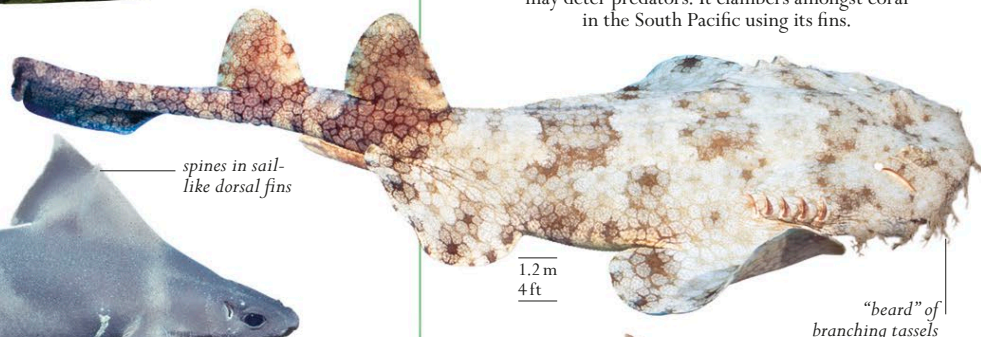
GREENLAND SHARK
Somniosus microcephalus
F: Somniosidae

One of only a few sharks that live in Arctic waters, this huge, sluggish shark often scavenges for drowned land animals.



ANGULAR ROUGHSHARK
Oxynotus centrina
F: Oxynotidae

Recently placed in its own order Echinorhynchiformes, this deep-water shark has two sail-like dorsal fins and rough skin. It lives in the E. Atlantic.



TASSELLED WOBBERGONG
Eucrossorhinus dasypogon
F: Orectolobidae

With its fringe of skin tassels, flattened body, and camouflage pattern, this S.W. Pacific coral reef resident is hard to spot.

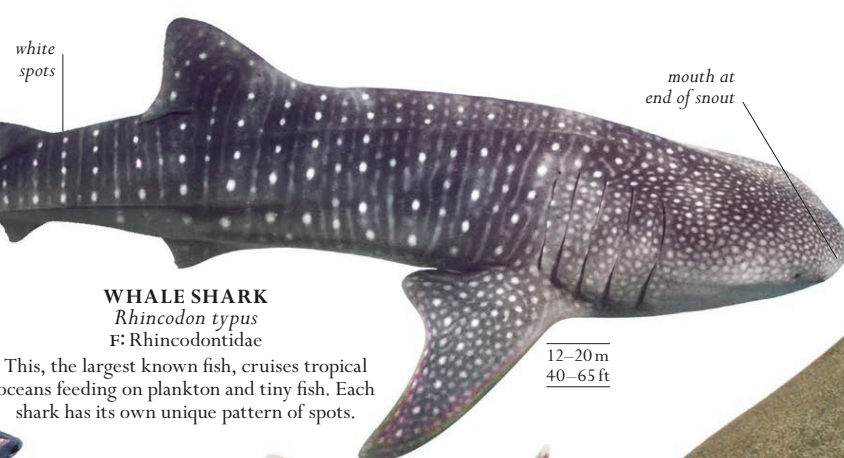


NURSE SHARK
Ginglymostoma cirratum
F: Ginglymostomatidae

By day this shark lies hidden in rock crevices, emerging at night to hunt in the warm coastal waters of the Atlantic and the E. Pacific.

CARPET SHARKS

The 46 or so sharks of the Orectolobiformes have two dorsal fins, one anal fin, and sensory barbels hanging down from the nostrils. With the exception of the whale shark, they live quietly on the seabed, feeding on fish and invertebrates.



WHALE SHARK
Rhincodon typus
F: Rhincodontidae

This, the largest known fish, cruises tropical oceans feeding on plankton and tiny fish. Each shark has its own unique pattern of spots.

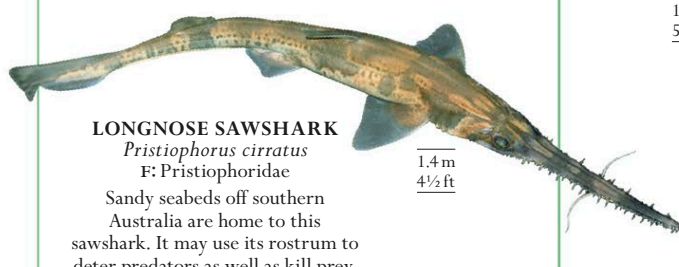


EPAULETTE CATSHARK
Hemiscyllium ocellatum
F: Hemiscylliidae

The bold eyespot mark of this long-tailed shark may deter predators. It clambers amongst coral in the South Pacific using its fins.

SAWSHARKS

Sawsharks have a flat head with gills on the sides and a long snout (rostrum) with teeth on the underside and edges. Two long sensory barbels hang from the rostrum and help find buried food. Most of the nine species of Pristiophoriformes live in the tropics.



LONGNOSE SAWSHARK
Pristiophorus cirratus
F: Pristiophoridae

Sandy seabeds off southern Australia are home to this sawshark. It may use its rostrum to deter predators as well as kill prey.

BULLHEAD SHARKS

The Heterodontiformes are small bottom-living sharks with a blunt, sloping head, crushing teeth, and two dorsal (back) fins each preceded by a sharp spine. They lay unique spiral-shaped eggs.



PORT JACKSON SHARK
Heterodontus portusjacksoni
F: Heterodontidae

Using its paddle-like front fins, this shark crawls over the seabed off southern Australia in search of sea urchins to eat.